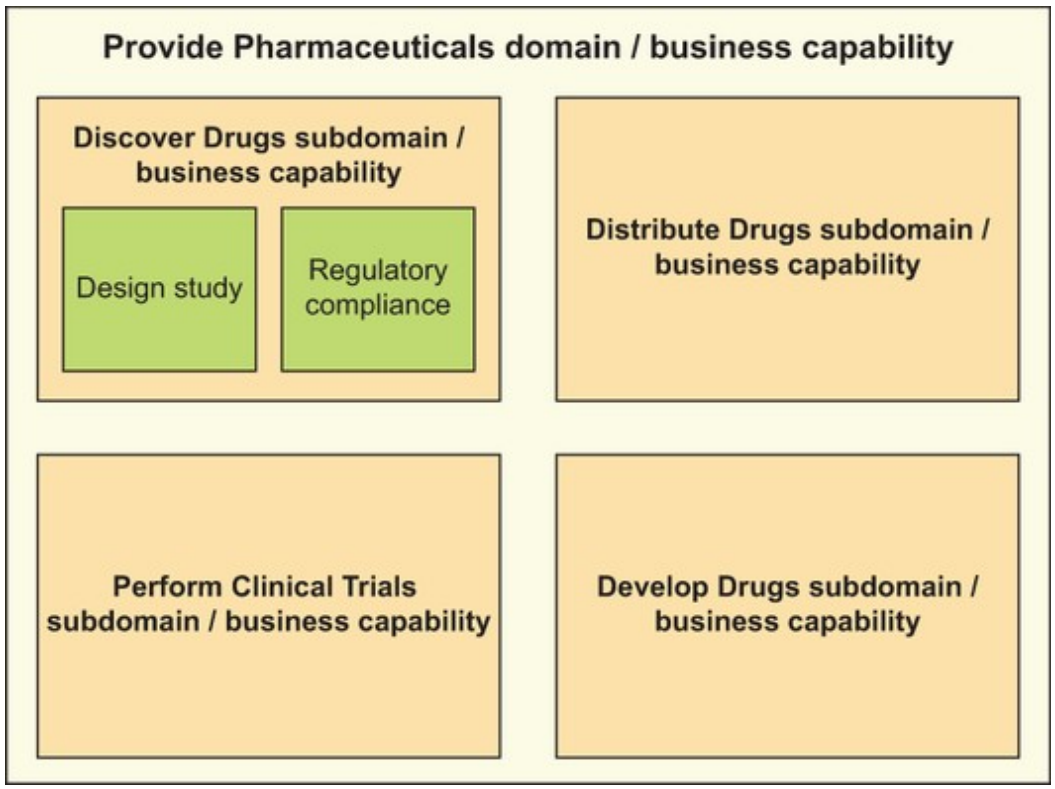


Figure 4.5 Domains and subdomains of a pharmaceutical company

Let's see what makes *business capability* a more precise definition in our context. A *business capability* is what a business can do. It focuses on *what*, not *how* or *who*. It is defined by its *outcome*, which is usually expressed as a qualitative rather than quantitative measure. *What* we are trying to do or achieve in business changes slowly, while *how* we are doing it or *who* will be doing it can change often. This is why *business capability* maps are time resilient.

By focusing on the *outcome*, we give ourselves the freedom to do and change whatever is needed to deliver as much business value as possible. Therefore, we should also focus on the *outcome* (qualitative), not the *output* (quantitative). For example, if we organize a birthday party for children, it doesn't really matter how many cakes, toys, chairs, and tables we prepare (quantitative output). What matters is happy and smiling kids after the party (qualitative outcome); how we achieve that is of secondary concern.

Business capability should be phrased as a verb-noun combination, and this structure will help us focus on the *activity* and its *outcome*. Table 4.1 shows